

087. Chapter 6 verses 33-35

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

VERSE 6.33

अर्जुन उवाच ।
योऽयं योगस्त्वया प्रोक्तः साम्येन मधुसूदन ।
एतस्याहं न पश्यामि चञ्चलत्वात्स्थितिं स्थिराम् ॥ ३३ ॥

arjuna uvāca |
yo'yaṁ yogastvayā proktaḥ
sāmyena madhusūdana |
etasyāhaṁ na paśyāmi
cañcalatvātsthitiṁ sthirām

◆ arjunaḥ uvāca – Arjuna said; ◆ yaḥ ayam – this; yogaḥ – Yoga; tvayā – by You; proktaḥ – taught; ◆ sāmyena – as equality/equanimity; madhusūdana – O Madhusudana; ◆ etasya – of this; aham – I; na paśyāmi – do not see; ◆ cañcalatvāt – because of restlessness; sthitim – foundation/steady state; sthirām – lasting;

Arjuna said: The system of Yoga that you have described and attainable by equality of mind, O Madhusudana, appears impractical and unattainable to me, due to the restless mind.

VERSE 6.34

चञ्चलं हि मनः कृष्ण प्रमाथि बलवद्दृढम् ।
तस्याहं निग्रहं मन्ये वायोरिव सुदुष्करम् ॥ 34 ॥

cañcalam hi manaḥ kṛṣṇa
pramāthi balavaddṛḍham |
tasyāham nigrahaṁ manye
vāyoriva suduṣkaram ||

◆ cañcalam – restless; hi – indeed; manaḥ – the mind; kṛṣṇa – O Krishna; ◆
pramāthi – turbulent; balavat – strong; dṛḍham – stubborn; ◆ tasya – of it; aham
– I; nigraham – control; manye – think; ◆ vāyoḥ iva – like the wind; su-
duṣkaram – very difficult.

The mind is very restless, turbulent, strong, and obstinate, O Krishna. It appears to me that it is more difficult to control than the wind.

VERSE 6.35

श्रीभगवानुवाच ।
असंशयं महाबाहो मनो दुर्निग्रहं चलम् ।
अभ्यासेन तु कौन्तेय वैराग्येण च गृह्यते ॥ 35 ॥

śrībhagavānuvāca |
asaṁśayaṁ mahābāho
mano durnigrahaṁ calam |
abhyāsenā tu kaunteya
vairāgyeṇa ca gr̥hyate ||

◆ śrī-bhagavān uvāca – The Blessed Lord said; ◆ asaṁśayaṁ – without doubt; mahābāho – O mighty-armed; ◆ manaḥ – the mind; durnigrahaṁ – difficult to curb; calam – restless; ◆ abhyāsenā – by practice; tu – but; kaunteya – O son of Kunti; ◆ vairāgyeṇa – by dispassion/detachment; ca – and; gr̥hyate – is restrained;

The Lord said: Doubtless, O mighty Arjuna, the mind is restless and hard to control; but by practice and by detachment, O son of Kunti, it can be restrained.